ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA : 3.64) in the Third Cycle) &
Graded as Category-I University by MHRD-UGC)

Karaikudi

Date : 28.03.2018

The inaugural function of a Two-Day International Conference on "Making India – From Tradition to Modernity: Domestic Issues and Global Challenges" was held at Alagappa University, Karaikudi, today (28.03.2018). In the conference, organized under the aegis of the Department of History, 100 scholars including international scholars are participating in it.

Presiding over the conclave, Prof. S. Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor, Alagappa University, said that India is admired all over the world for its rich cultural heritage. Taking good aspects of tradition and culture of a people from one generation to another is one of the important objectives of education. Learning of history helps one to understand the culture of a nation. Achieving unity in diversity is an ongoing process even after 70 years of India's independence and it is cultural unity that has been binding the people of India for thousands of years. Even in the ancient days India remained a super power as for higher education was concerned. In the ancient Nalanda University, there were 2000 teachers for 10,000 students who could reside in one campus. This showed the keen interest evinced in giving proper and effective education and it attracted students from the neighbouring countries.

Referring to various domestic challenges such as population explosion, empowering the youth and women for sustainable development, he said that the highest human capital in India -- next only to China -- is a positive aspect but at the same time providing food, shelter and employment to the teeming millions has been an ever growing challenge to successive governments. The planners in the country are acutely aware of the importance of skilling the

population for sustainable development of the nation. Only through quality education, India can compete at the global market with developed countries. Another challenge in India is to provide equal space to women so as to empower them to take part in all developmental activities. He added that while concentrating on technology development, environmental problems have to be taken into account as leaving a less polluted earth to the posterity becomes our duty.

Prof. N. Rajendran, Visiting Professor, in his thematic address, said that history is the basis of all knowledge. A proper perception of history reveals that India is not simply a nation but a great civilization. Toynbee, a great historian, who analyzed more than 26 world civilizations, has remarked that India and China are the two living civilizations in the world. He added that the broad based theme of the seminar has provided an opportunity for scholars to discuss contemporary domestic and international challenges that India is facing today; and an array of 85 research papers received on various issues affecting the nation and the globe point to the great relevance of the topic of this conference.

In his special address, Prof. Jeyagobi Dhamodarem, Dean, Faculty of Arts, Institute Pendidikan Guru, Kampus Pendidikan Islam, Malaysia, stated that the learning of more than one language would be of great advantage to youngsters and said that the learning of English by Indians have helped them get jobs at the global level. He asked the students to learn Asian Languages that would fetch them employment opportunities in other countries. The Malaysians of Indian origin have been following the Indian tradition and culture.

Dr. S. Anuzyiya of South Eastern University of Sri Lanka, in her felicitation address, said that India had maintained good relations with neighbouring countries which mutually benefitted the countries involved. She also made a reference to the remarkable Indus Valley Civilization which proclaimed the genius of the Indian mind and modernity of the ancient Indian culture. The taste derived from the learning of history gives the power to articulate and achieve greater things pragmatically in life.

While offering felicitations, Dr. K. Manimekalai, Dean, Faculty of Arts, Alagappa University, said that all good practices of the great Indian tradition should be perpetuated and at the same time modernity cannot be ignored.

A souvenir containing 85 abstracts of research papers was released on the occasion.

Dr. K. Krishnamoorthy, Head i/c., Department of History, welcomed the gathering. Dr. G. Paranthaman, Assistant Professor, Department of History, proposed a vote of thanks.

Prof. H. Gurumallesh Prabu

Registrar